



LGBTQ+ YOUTH IN SCHOOLS

Multicultural Group Project

AUDREY, DALAYIA, LEXIE, AND SYDNEY

COUNSELING LGBTQ+ STUDENTS



PEOPLE AND HISTORY



CHALLENGES



STRENGTHS



ASSETS



ACTIVITIES



POSITIONALITIES



IMPLICATIONS



REFERENCES

KNOWLEDGE CHECK!

- 1. What does 'LGBTQ+' stand for?**
- 2. What percentage of middle/high schools have Gay Straight Alliances?**
- 3. What percentage of LGBTQ+ students heard "gay" used in a negative way at school?**



Equal
rights

HISTORY



HISTORY PART ONE

The term 'Lesbian' first used by author William King - a woman who loved another woman.

1955

John Oliven first used the term 'transgender' - a person who identifies as another gender than what they were assigned at birth.

1965

1969

Gay pride marches held across the country to celebrate the anniversary of the Stonewall riots.

1970

1978

The Human Rights Campaign was founded in hopes to end discrimination against the LGBT community in health care and employment.

1980

2003

The APA updated the DSM-V to replace "gender identity disorder" to "gender dysphoria".

2013

The term 'Gay' was first heard in Eastern Europe earlier than this, but 1955 was the year 'gay' came to mean men loving men.

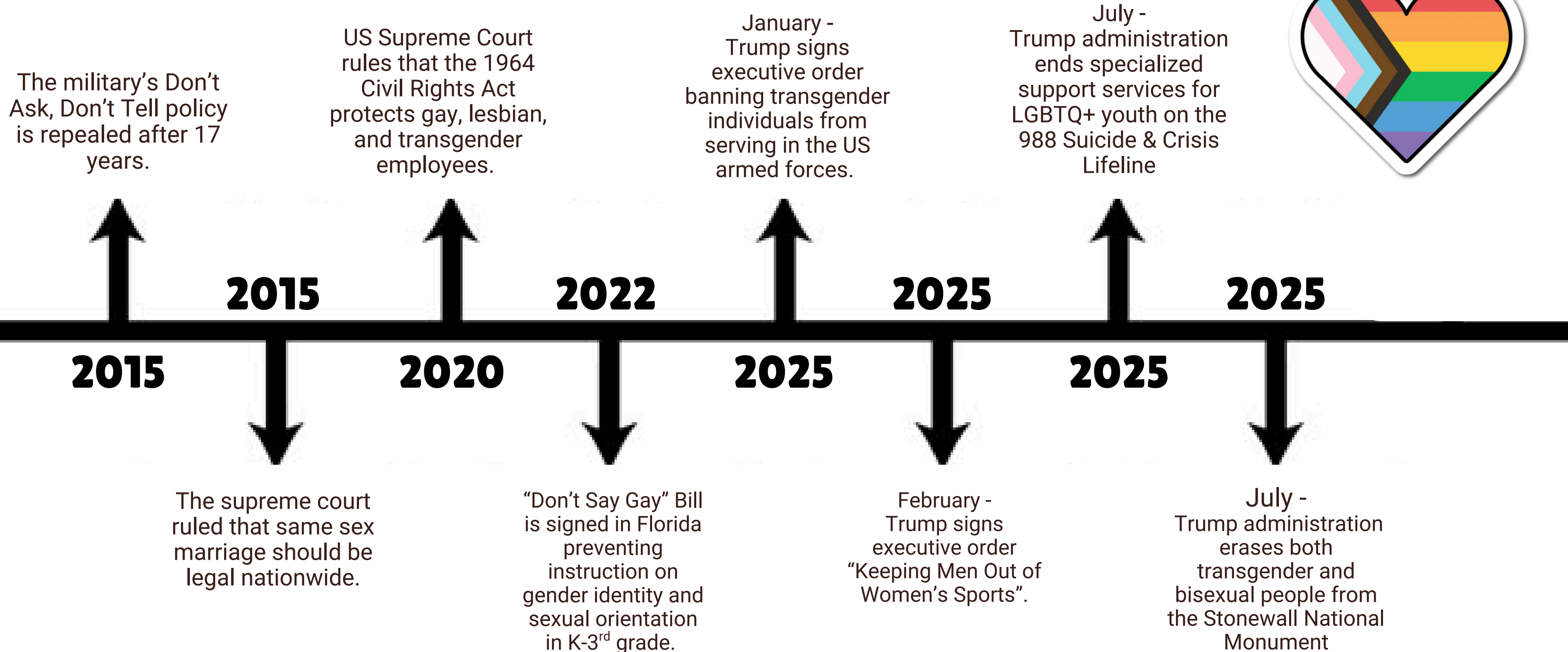


The Stonewall Riots took place in New York City - police conducted unprovoked police raid on the gay bar, The Stonewall Inn. (Shown Left)

The rainbow flag was flown during the Gay Freedom Parade in San Francisco; the flag then becomes a hallmark in the LGBT community.

Massachusetts became the first state to legalize same sex marriage.

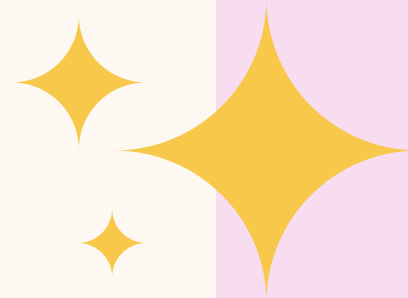
HISTORY PART TWO





CHALLENGES IN SCHOOLS

- Harassment/bullying
- Violence
- Discrimination
 - Use of dead name
 - Misgendering
 - Gender-specific dress codes
- Lack of community
 - No GSA in some schools
 - No resources and supports



PROTECTIVE FACTORS

- Supportive school policies
 - Chosen names and pronouns
 - Inclusive language
 - Gender inclusive practices
- Supportive adults
 - Counselors, teachers
 - School nurse
 - GSSC Safe Zone stickers
- Peer support
 - GSA presence

STRENGTHS AND ASSETS

COURAGE

SELF-AWARENESS

ORIGINALITY

RESILIENCE

INCLUSIVITY

COMMUNITY

SUPPORT AND ADVOCACY

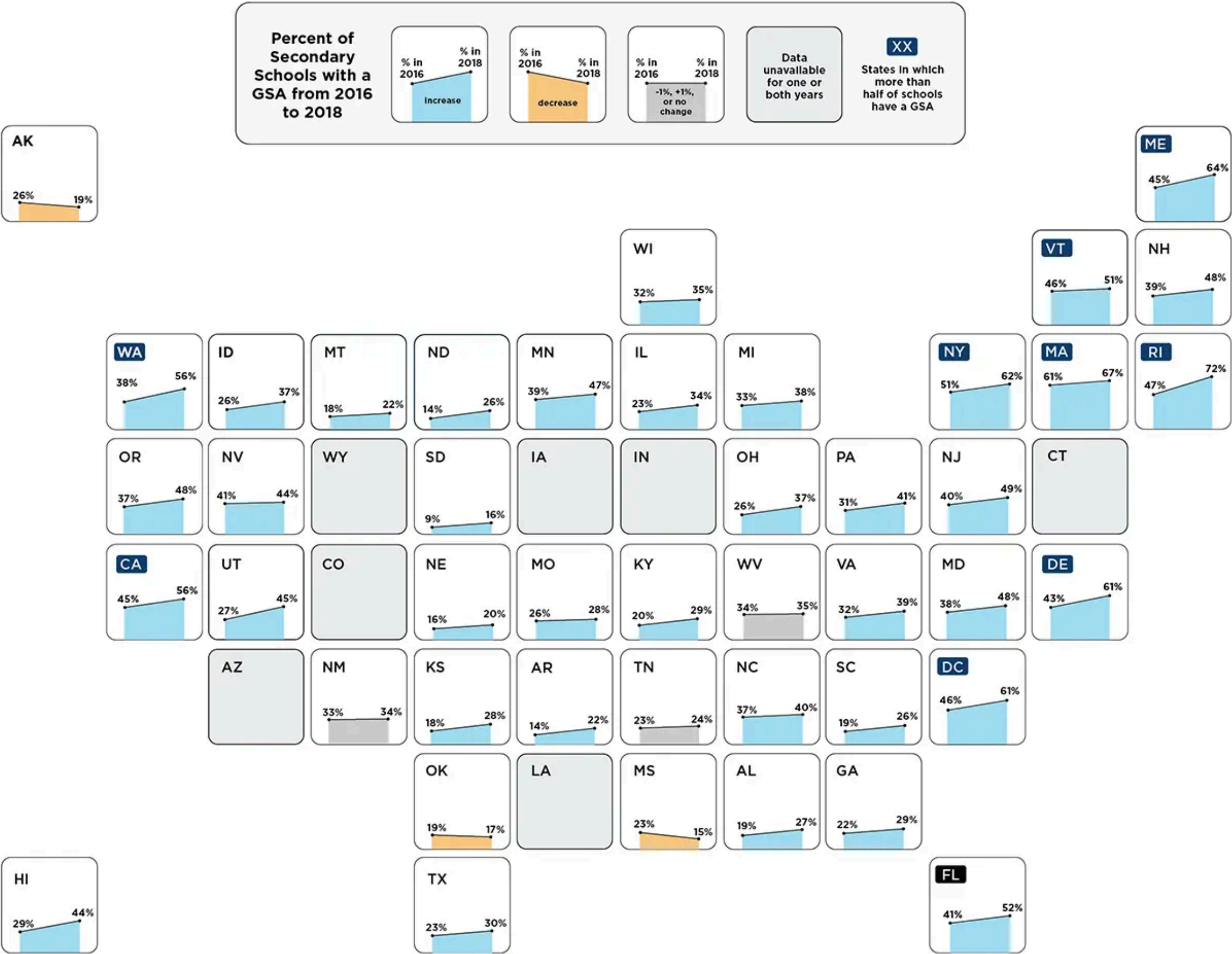
- Trevor Project
 - The Trevor Project is an organization that supports LGBTQ+ youth. It also provides educational resources and research to enhance understanding of LGBTQ+ mental health.
- Trevor Space
 - The Trevor Space is an online service offered by The Trevor Project that allows LGBTQ+ youth between the ages of 13 and 24 to connect, find community, and discover their identities in a supportive online space.
- The Safe Zone Project
 - The Safe Zone Project is a two-hour online training designed for educators to learn about LGBTQ+ identities, as well as gender and sexuality. Participants will examine issues related to prejudice, assumptions, and privilege. Upon completing the training, you will receive a "Safe Zone" sticker, which signals to students that you are a safe adult to approach regarding LGBTQ+ matters.

Gay Straight Alliance (GSA) - a student-led club that provides a safe space for LGBTQ+ students and their allies to meet, socialize, and organize around issues of sexual orientation and gender identity



Safe Zone - a designated area or environment where individuals feel secure, supported, and free from judgment or harm, particularly in the context of social or emotional well-being

Change in percentage of secondary schools with a Gender and Sexuality Alliance or Gay-Straight Alliance, 2016 to 2018



GSA PRESENCE
BY STATE
(2016 – 2018)



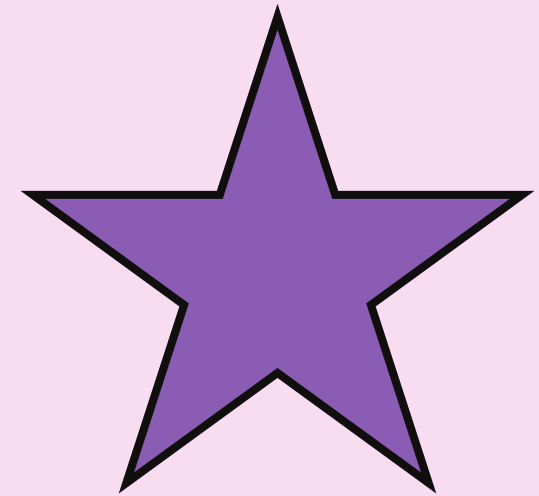
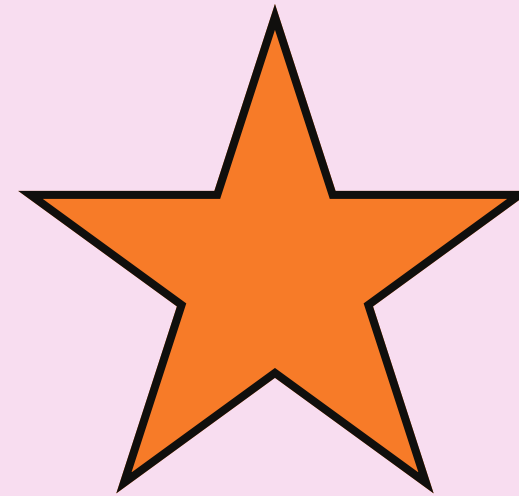
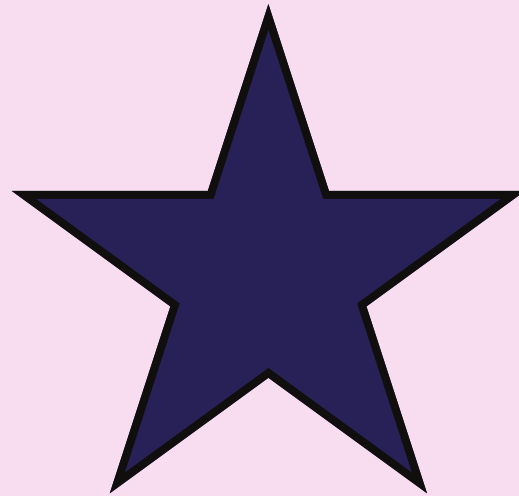
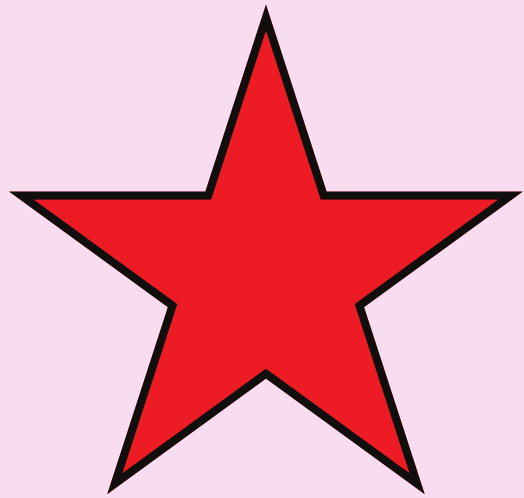
ACTIVITY TIME!

"COMING OUT" STARS!

- Activity goals
 - Build empathy
 - Be able to describe aspects of “coming out”
 - Describe impact on future relationships with LGBTQ+ peers
- Group Size
- Target group
 - Primarily non-LGBTQ+ youth
- Conducted by school counselors
 - Level of possible support needed



"COMING OUT" STARS



Everyone grab one star – red, blue, orange, or purple



DISCUSSION



HOW DID IT FEEL TO TAKE PART IN THIS ACTIVITY?

RED STARS – HOW DID THAT FEEL? BLUE STARS?

WHAT DID YOU LEARN FROM THIS ACTIVITY?

**WHAT DO YOU FEEL YOU CAN DO TO MAKE YOUR OFFICE A
MORE SUPPORTIVE PLACE FOR LGBTQ+ PEOPLE?**

SECOND ACTIVITY – ALLY OR BYSTANDER

Ally or Bystander — Situation Sheet

Review the list of scenarios and pick out ones that you think will generate discussion in your class or that you would like your students to consider. The goal is to spend time discussing and unpacking each scenario, not to get through all the scenarios in one lesson. Repeat the lesson as needed, students need a lot of processing, practicing and repetition to build and master these skills with enough confidence that they will apply their ally skills outside of their classrooms.

Scenarios for Grades K-5

1. A classmate (friend, older student, sibling) constantly makes fun of another student (your friend, younger student) because they are small for their age (tall, short, overweight).
2. A new kid (friend, sibling, classmate, someone you don't know) at school calls your friend (a stranger, your sibling, a classmate, new student) a bad name because of their religion (sexual orientation, gender expression).
3. A new student (older student, someone you don't know, a group of kids) at school calls your friend (someone you don't know, a classmate, a new student) "gay".
4. A student in your class (friend, sibling, older student) teases a boy (girl) for wearing a dress (long hair, short hair, nail polish, pink clothing, barrettes, 'boy clothes', baseball hat).
5. A girl in your class (friend, sibling, older student) teases another girl for always dressing (acting, playing) like a boy.

Scenarios for Grades 6-8

1. A group of students your age (your friend, classmate) keeps saying, "That's gay" to mean they don't like something.
2. A new student (friend, sibling, classmate, someone you don't know) calls your friend (a stranger, your sibling, a classmate, new student) a hurtful name because of their religion (sexual orientation, gender expression).
3. When you are with a group of friends, one of them makes fun of a younger student (new student, friend, someone you kind of know, someone you don't know) because of the way they dress (sound, look, act).
4. A classmate (friend, older student, sibling) constantly makes fun of another student (your friend, younger student) because they are small for their age (tall, short, overweight).
5. A friend (another student, an older student, someone you don't know well) of yours keeps telling one of the boys (kids, girls), "Stop acting like a girl!" (acting like a boy, dressing like a boy, dressing like a girl).

Scenarios for Grades 9-12

1. Your friend (classmate) says, "Oh, that assignment was so gay."

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2. A student you don't know well (friend, classmate, older student) says, "Ask Xiao Ming for the answer; all Asians are good at math."
3. You overhear a younger student tell their friend, "It's Jace's fault he gets bullied because he never wears clean clothes."
4. When you are with a group of friends, one of them makes fun of someone you kind of know (new student, friend, someone you don't know) because of the way they dress (sound, look, act).
5. A new student (friend, sibling, classmate, someone you don't know) uses an insult/slur toward your friend (a stranger, your sibling, a classmate, new student) related to their skin color (religion, sexual orientation, gender expression, ethnicity).

Include any others that might apply to your school or community.

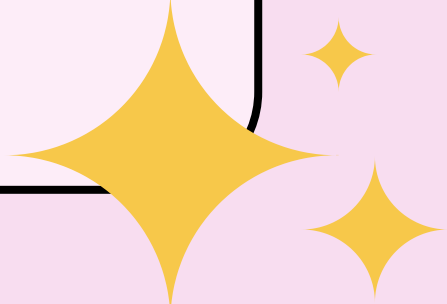
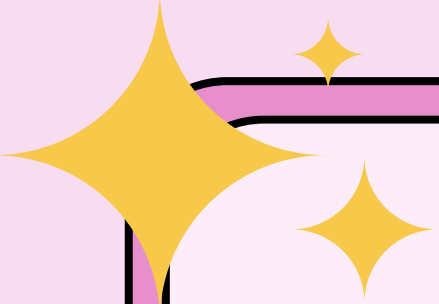
**IGNORE THE SITUATION
OR WALK AWAY**

INTERVENE MYSELF

**TALK TO THE PERSON
IN PRIVATE**

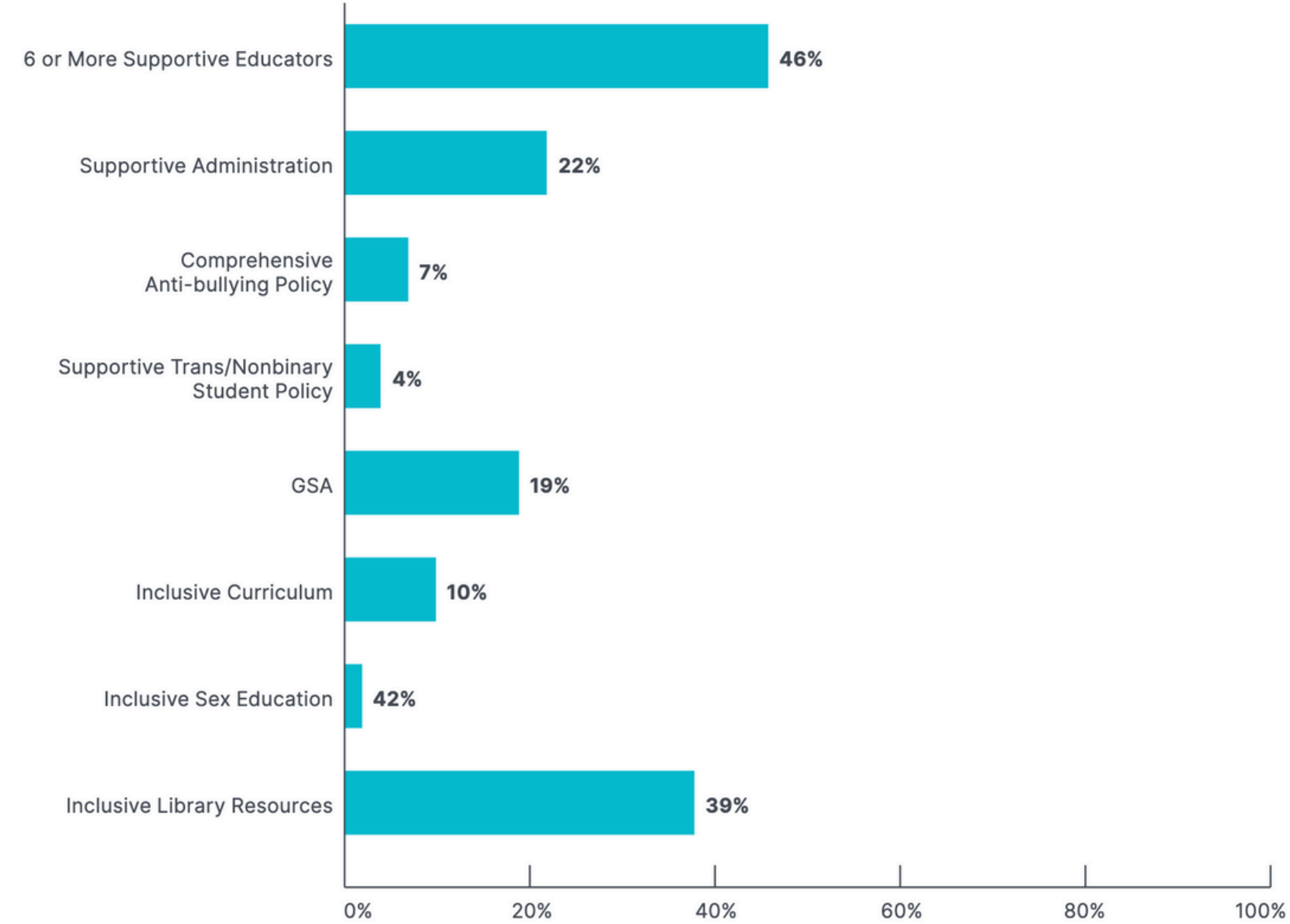
**SEEK HELP FROM AN
ADULT OR SOMEONE
OLDER**

(Welcoming Schools, n.d.)



IMPLICATIONS FOR SCHOOL COUNSELING

Figure 4. Availability of LGBTQ+-Related and Supports in Georgia Schools

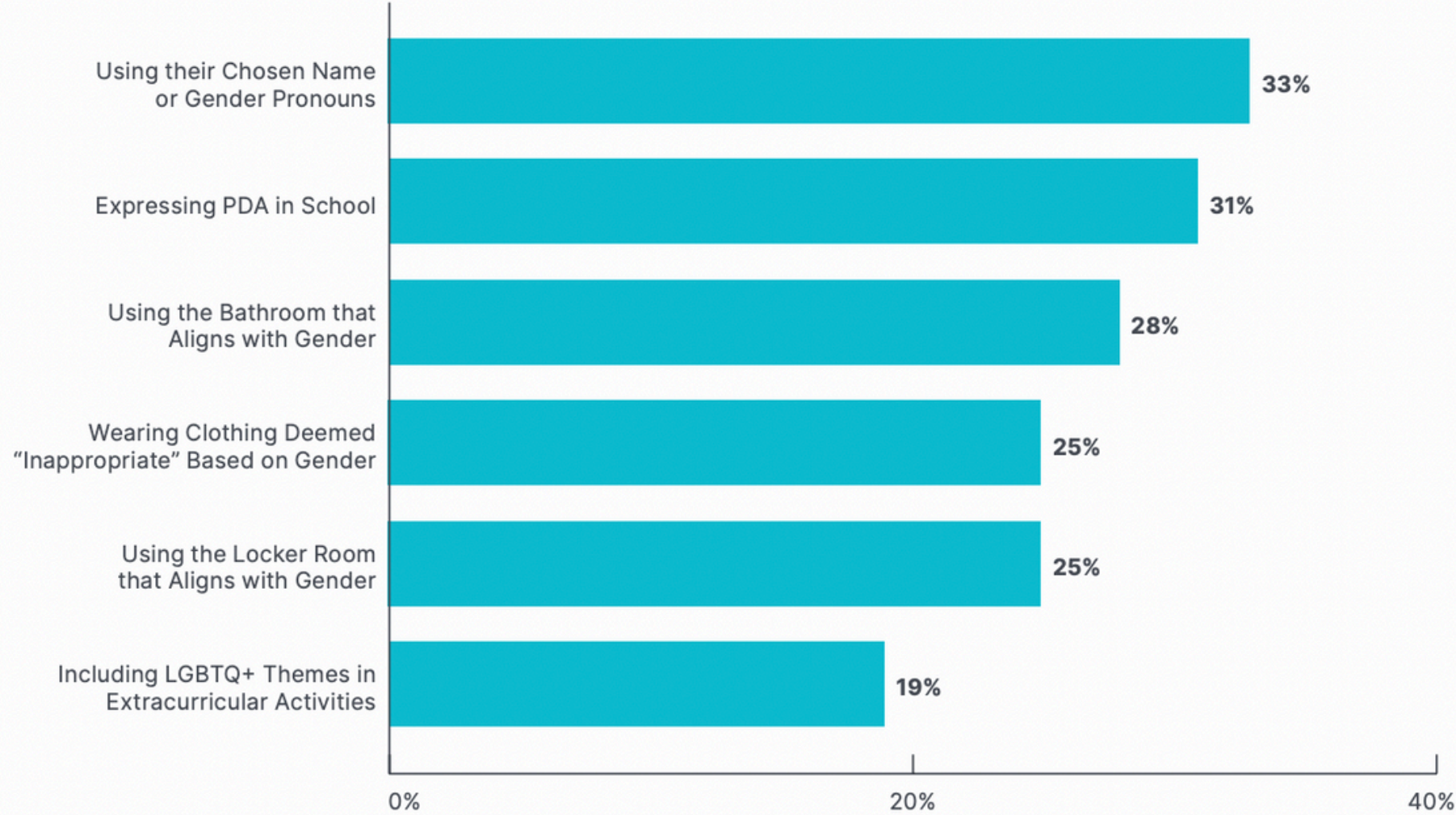


(GLSEN, 2023)



(GLSEN, 2023)

Figure 3. Anti-LGBTQ+ Discrimination in Georgia Schools
(percentage of LGBTQ+ students prevented from...)



Statistics

61.5% of LGBTQ+ students who were harassed or assaulted in school did not report the incident to school staff, most often because they did not think school staff would do anything about the harassment.

60.3% of the students who did report an incident said that school staff did nothing in response or told the student to ignore it.

LGBTQ+ students who did experience victimization were nearly three times as likely to have missed school in the past month than those who experienced lower levels (60.7% vs. 23.3%)

Share:   

39% of LGBTQ+ young people seriously considered attempting suicide in the past year

including almost half of transgender and nonbinary young people (46%) and 3 in 10 cisgender young people (30%).

Share:   

12% of LGBTQ+ young people attempted suicide in the past year

including 14% of transgender and nonbinary young people and 7% of cisgender young people.

More than half (54%) of transgender and nonbinary young people found their school to be gender-affirming, and those who did reported lower rates of attempting suicide.



Role of School Counselor

- Understanding and supporting LGBTQ+ students
- The Counselor's role in fostering student well-being
- Confidentiality and ethical responsibility

POSITIONALITY



AUDREY

Lesbian –

White –

Cisgender woman –

Affected by heteronormativity –

DALAYIA

– Pansexual

– Black

– Cisgender

– Aware of identity since elementary, but not out



POSITIONALITY



LEXIE

White, cisgender, bisexual woman –

Married to a man –

Came out later in life –

SYDNEY

- White, straight woman**
- Ally**
- Lesbian parents**
- Bisexual sister**





THANK YOU!

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